

COSMIC RETRO PLANTS

Plant Switcher V3

Quick Start & User Guide

One prefab. Multiple growth stages. Multiple pots.

- Switch between Empty, L1, L2 and L3 directly in the Unity Inspector.
- Swap pot variants without rebuilding the prefab manually.
- Randomize stages and pots for fast scene dressing.
- Works in Edit Mode for an immediate visual preview.

Designed for the Cosmic Retro plant collection

Unity 2022.3 LTS or newer recommended

The PolynestLab

Quick Start

Set up a configurable plant prefab in a few minutes.

1. Add the component

Add CR_PlantSwitcherV3 to the root GameObject of your configurable plant prefab.

CR_Plant_01

|- Plant Slot

|- Pot Slot

The two slots are empty child transforms.

2. Assign growth stages

- Plant Stages [0] = L1
- Plant Stages [1] = L2
- Plant Stages [2] = L3
- Use the Empty button when you want the pot or scene to contain no plant.

3. Assign pot variants

Add any compatible pot prefabs to Pot Variants. The same pot library can be reused across all configurable plant prefabs.

4. Set plant height

Select a pot, move Plant Slot upward until the plant sits correctly at the soil level, then press 'Use Current Plant Slot Y As Pot Height'. When Pot is set to None, the plant automatically returns to Plant Y Without Pot (normally Y = 0).

Inspector Controls

What each button does.

Empty

Removes the plant while keeping the pot selection intact.

L1 / L2 / L3

Switches between the three growth stages assigned to the prefab.

Previous / Next

Cycles through growth stages or pot variants.

Random - Growth

Selects a real growth stage. Empty is never chosen randomly.

None - Pot

Removes the pot and places the plant at Plant Y Without Pot.

Random - Pot

Selects a real pot variant. None is never chosen randomly.

Randomize All

Randomizes both the plant growth stage and pot in one click.

Rebuild All

Recreates the current preview using the selected stage and pot.

Clear Preview

Removes generated preview objects from both slots.

Create / Repair Slots

Creates Plant Slot and Pot Slot if they are missing.

Recommended Workflow

Fast setup for large plant libraries.

Prefab organization

For a large collection, create one configurable root prefab per species. Each root references its own L1, L2 and L3 assets, while all species can share the same pot prefabs.

Example

CR_Plant_17

Plant Stages

- [0] CR_Plant_17_L1
- [1] CR_Plant_17_L2
- [2] CR_Plant_17_L3

Pot Variants

- [0] CR_Plant_Pot_01
- [1] CR_Plant_Pot_02

Pivot recommendations

- Plant pivot: centered at the bottom / soil contact point.
- Pot pivot: centered at its intended placement point.
- Keep Plant Slot and Pot Slot at local rotation (0,0,0) and scale (1,1,1).
- Use Plant Y With Pot only for the vertical offset required by the pot.

Performance

The switcher is intentionally lightweight. It does not run continuous update logic. Changes are performed when you use the Inspector controls or call the public methods. In-game performance is therefore dominated by the meshes, materials, textures, lighting and number of visible objects rather than the configurator itself.

Troubleshooting

Common setup issues.

The plant floats above the floor

Set Pot to None and make sure Plant Y Without Pot is 0. Also verify that the plant mesh pivot is at its base.

The plant sits too low or too high in a pot

Select a pot, adjust Plant Slot Y in the Scene view, then click 'Use Current Plant Slot Y As Pot Height'.

Nothing changes when I press L1/L2/L3

Check that Plant Stages contains valid prefabs or GameObjects and that Plant Slot is assigned.

The pot does not appear

Check that Pot Variants contains valid prefabs and that Pot Slot is assigned.

Objects appear with an unexpected offset

Check the source prefab pivots and make sure Reset Spawned Local Transform is enabled.

I do not want to use the script

You can use the included standard plant and pot prefabs directly. The configurator is an optional workflow helper.

Tip

Keep the configurable prefabs separate from the standard drag-and-drop prefabs. This gives users both a simple workflow and an advanced growth-system workflow.